Outlook

Re: 7/09/2026—RTSL UW CVH Modeling Research Meeting Notes

From Zina Abourjeily <zabourjeily@resolvetosavelives.org>
Date Tue 7/14/2026 2:52 PM
To William R Garcia <wrgg@uw.edu>
Cc David Watkins <davidaw@uw.edu>; Laura Cobb <lcobb@resolvetosavelives.org>; mmarklu1 <mmarklu1@jhu.edu>; Andrew Moran <amoran@resolvetosavelives.org>; Nicole Ide <nide@resolvetosavelives.org>

Hi William,

Some follow up on outstanding questions from last meeting.

- Behavior change/mass media: do not include
- LSS: scenarios 4 & 5 only are fine for now, but please investigate incorporating household uptake (note that this is different from the notes below)
- Sources of sodium: have been updated as of today, to reflect a decrease in sodium from public food procurement given the model does not include children and thus schools
- Matti is working on getting estimates of increases in packaged food using Euromintor data and has shared the paper on price elasticities

Lastly, have you decided on a ramp-up time for the interventions, or do you need our input on this?

Very Best,
Zina

From: Zina Abourjeily <zabourjeily@resolvetosavelives.org>
Date: Thursday, July 9, 2026 at 6:45 PM
To: William R Garcia <wrgg@uw.edu>; Nicole Ide <nide@resolvetosavelives.org>; Andrew Moran <amoran@resolvetosavelives.org>; mmarklu1 <mmarklu1@jhu.edu>
Cc: davidaw <davidaw@uw.edu>; Laura Cobb <lcobb@resolvetosavelives.org>
Subject: Re: 7/09/2026—RTSL UW CVH Modeling Research Meeting Notes

Thank you for the slides and your presentation, William! Pasted below are the notes. Please feel free to reply with anything I may have missed, incorrectly captured, or needs further clarification. Please also refer to this shared document for any questions on source data, which includes rationale for effect size determination and which policies are thus modeled.

Fiscal Policy

- **Country-Specific Price Elasticities:** David raised concerns about the variability of price elasticities across countries and food components, noting that fiscal policy effects would likely be highly country- and component-specific, unlike homogeneous products such as cigarettes.

- **Modeling Approach and Data Sources:** Matti described the use of price elasticities from the Philippines national survey in previous studies, suggesting that meta-analyses stratified by income level could inform the modeling, but highlighted uncertainties due to reliance on high-income country data.
- **Policy Framing:** Zina clarified that fiscal policy (similar to FOPL) is not limited to salt tax but includes foods classified by nutrient profile models; but for the purposes of this effort, we are only interested on the impact on sodium intake and subsequent BP effects.
- **Next Steps for Fiscal Policy Modeling:** William and Matti agreed to seek relevant meta-analyses and further data to enrich the fiscal policy discussion

Low-Sodium Salt Substitution

- **Mechanistic vs. Trial-Based Modeling:** William described two modeling approaches:
  - applying a 15% sodium reduction to discretionary salt based on the SSaaSS
  - or directly using effect sizes (OR and RR) from the Salt Substitute and Stroke Study (SSaSS) to model impacts on incidence and mortality → this would capture potassium effects without having to recreate a model that incorporates this (in progress)
    - Matti flagged that this would need to adjusted according to countries discretionary sodium use, as China's is quite high
- **Population Targeting :**
  - William presented scenarios 4 and 5, which only target the hypertensive population
    - This only included the hypertensive population and not household uptake
    - David raised concerns about expanding to the household as it adds more parameters, but some in between is needed as it is not realistic that only a hypertensive individual and not the household salt would change
  - Zina flagged that previous discussions had mentioned inclusion of scenario 2 (discretionary replacement for the whole population), assuming a certain level of coverage that can be "toggled"
    - David raised concerns that this is more of a clinical intervention, but Zina and Nicole clarified that RTSL is working to expand LSS to broader populations and highly utilized condiments that are significant sources of sodium in some countries; it's important that the results align with RTSLs work
  - Notes from previous meeting on this topic:
    - **General population:**
      - Model replacement of discretionary salt.
      - Define a coverage percentage that can be manually adjusted.
    - **Hypertensive population:**
      - Use the same coverage assumption as the HTN/HEARTS model (~33%).
      - Assume household-level adoption (based on SSaaSS trial), using country-specific household size to scale coverage.
      - Ensure the model remains flexible to update coverage assumption

Intervention Effect Sizes and Policy Benchmarking

- **Benchmarking Against Previous Studies:** Andrew suggested indexing the current results against the 100 million lives paper to provide context and facilitate benchmarking—William to look at comparison

- **Intervention Effect Size Interpretation:** Team was surprised by the unexpectedly high effect sizes for behavior change and media campaigns, with William explaining that these interventions target both discretionary and packaged sources, thus covering a large proportion of sodium intake.
- **Public Procurement Assumptions:** public procurement was fixed at 5% of sodium intake due to limited data, but estimates assumed school coverage. RTSL team to revisit this number since modeling is only in the adult population (Nicole/Zina due-out)

Pending Decisions and Next Steps:

- **Fiscal Policy Inclusion:** yes—include
- **LSS Scenario Specification:** include scenario 2, as well
- **Observation Period Harmonization:** need to harmonize effect sizes measured over varying observation periods, considering whether to apply them as end-state at full scale-up or linearly over the observed window
- **Source-Share Data:** No GDP estimates were provided in the document, all from literature search
- **Implementation Dynamics and Assumptions:** Andrew and William discussed assumptions regarding policy ramp-up times, implementation dynamics, and the need for internal consistency across different work streams
- **Projections for packaged food:** the model currently assumes packaged food consumption remains constant → this is something RTSL would like adjusted
    - Request assistance from JHU to look at trends in packaged/UPF consumption/purchases using Euromonitor data in the priority countries (Zina to reach out)
    -

Publication Plans and Policy Tool Development (TBD—technical team needs to revisit this): discussed plans to work the sodium policy paper after the August deliverable, considering the inclusion of economic analyses and engagement with country authors, and outlined next steps for developing an interactive policy tool.

- **Economic Analysis and Author Engagement:** David emphasized the importance of including value-for-money considerations and engaging authors from the studied countries in the publication process
- **Policy Tool Development:** Andrew outlined plans to develop an interactive policy tool following completion of the sodium policy paper, with the team agreeing to allocate time in future meetings for next steps discussions.

Follow-up tasks:

- UW
    - Add fiscal policy to the model
    - Add scenario 2 to LSS modeling
    - Potassium impact of LSS is VERY important to include; so the new method is likely preferable
    - Investigate what it looks like to add household uptake to scenario 4 and 5 of the LSS model
    - Share updates over email before July 23 meeting so that we can discuss changes
- RTSL
    - Discuss whether or not to include behavior change/mass media
    - Re-evaluate the 5% sodium source assumption for public procurement

- Coordinate with Matti and Megan to obtain recent Euromonitor data for packaged food consumption projections in priority countries and share relevant information with William

From: William R Garcia <wrgg@uw.edu>
Date: Thursday, July 9, 2026 at 5:20 PM
To: Zina Abourjeily <zabourjeily@resolvetosavelives.org>; Nicole Ide <nide@resolvetosavelives.org>; Andrew Moran <amoran@resolvetosavelives.org>; mmarklu1 <mmarklu1@jhu.edu>
Cc: davidaw <davidaw@uw.edu>; Laura Cobb <lcobb@resolvetosavelives.org>
Subject: 7/09/2026—RTSL UW CVH Modeling Research Meeting Notes

Dear All,

Thank you all for the productive call today. I'm attaching today's slides here for the record.

@Zina, I appreciate you sharing your AI-assisted notes.

Best,

William Garcia
PhD Candidate, Health Metrics & Implementation Science
University of Washington

Outlook

Price-elasticities by country income level

From Matti Marklund <mmarklu1@jhu.edu>
Date Tue 7/14/2026 10:26 AM
To William R Garcia <wrgg@uw.edu>; David Watkins <davidaw@uw.edu>
Cc Zina Abourjeily <zabourjeily@resolvetosavelives.org>; Nicole Ide <nide@resolvetosavelives.org>; Laura Cobb <lcobb@resolvetosavelives.org>; Andrew Moran <amoran@resolvetosavelives.org>

2 attachments (437 KB)

Green et al - BMJ - 2013 - Suppl.pdf; Green et al - BMJ - 2013.pdf;

Hi William and David,

I have attached the paper with price-elasticities stratified by country income level that I mentioned on our call last week. Happy to discuss if and how this can be used in this project. I am out of office Wed-Fri this week but will be back next week.

Let me know if you have any questions.

Thanks,

Matti

Outlook

Re: Packaged food trend estimates for sodium modelling

From William R Garcia <wrgg@uw.edu>
Date Tue 7/21/2026 5:35 PM
To Matti Marklund <mmarklu1@jhu.edu>
Cc David Watkins <davidaw@uw.edu>; Zina Abourjeily <zabourjeily@resolvetosavelives.org>; Nicole Ide <nide@resolvetosavelives.org>; lcobb <lcobb@resolvetosavelives.org>

Hi Matti,

Thanks for sharing, this looks great! On our side, we'll adapt the model to include a trend assumption that can be incorporated based on the inputs. Happy to discuss this further during Thursday's meeting.

Best,

William

From: Matti Marklund <mmarklu1@jhu.edu>
Sent: Tuesday, July 21, 2026 4:07 PM
To: William R Garcia <wrgg@uw.edu>
Cc: David Watkins <davidaw@uw.edu>; Zina Abourjeily <zabourjeily@resolvetosavelives.org>; Nicole Ide <nide@resolvetosavelives.org>; lcobb <lcobb@resolvetosavelives.org>
Subject: Packaged food trend estimates for sodium modelling

Hi William and all,

Please find attached an Excel file with trend estimates for a selected set of packaged food categories calculated from the Euromonitor that are likely to be important sources of dietary sodium. A brief description of the selected categories, the workbook structure, and the trend measures used is provided in first sheet (README).

The workbook includes:

- All observed years (2011–2025)
- Post-COVID period (2023–2025)
- Last observed year and Euromonitor predictions (2025–2030)

I am happy to discuss this in more detail, including which estimates may be most appropriate to use and whether we should attempt to combine some.

Best regards,

Matti